Collaborative governance: selected definitions

G&H: *"collectively crafting a policy or recommendations to decision-maker(s) … the locus of authority often remains with government…"* (Gollagher and Hartz-Karp, 2013: 2348)

A&G: *"public agencies directly engage non-state stakeholders in a collective decision-making process that is formal, consensus-oriented, and deliberative and that aims to make or implement public policy or manage public programs or assets"* (Ansell and Gash, 2008: 544)

E: *"Our definition does not limit collaborative governance to only formal, state-initiated arrangements,… [it encompasses] 'multi-partner governance'… hybrid arrangements such as public-private, private-social partnerships and co-management regimes. It also includes the myriad of community-based collaboratives"* (Emerson et al., 2011: 3)

B: *"collaboration across the broadest scope of government work in the policy process, not only establishing laws and rules but also practices for management and implementation… the phrase 'policy process' … includes but is not limited to identifying and defining a public policy issue, defining the options for a new policy framework, expanding the range of options, identifying approaches for addressing an issue, setting priorities among approaches"* (Bingham, 2011: 3)

Collaborative governance

2 main ways to define collaborative governance:

- A narrow definition
- A broader definition

Narrow definition

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- Who?
- For what?

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